“All right. I’m happy to help.” Rose glanced at the window. “I want to get back to the still life while the light’s good,” Rose said, standing.

Léa decided to go to the *chai* to run through her plan one more time just to be sure. Tomorrow, she would bring food to Édouard at the mairie, maybe her only chance to talk with him before she and Rose smuggled the wine.

At the *chai*, she found the door ajar, which surprised her because she thought she’d closed it. She stepped inside, heard noises at the back and hesitated. No one should be here. “Hello?” Her voice sounded sharp in the domed *chai*.

And then she saw him: a man, bent over what appeared to be one of the old barrels that she and Édouard had washed last week. With a crowbar, he was attempting to lift the barrel head. “What are you doing here?” she said, trying to sound less afraid than she felt.

He turned. “Get out.”

“No. You get out,” she shouted.

“Hush.” The barrel lid popped off, and he put it on the ground. Next to his feet stood an open canvas bag. He turned to face her. “Édouard sent me. I need to move what’s in this barrel. Now either help or leave me alone.”

“Who are you? How do I know that Édouard sent you?”

“I’m a friend of his and André’s. I’ve been instructed to move these.” He turned back and lifted a rifle out of the barrel, holding it up. “Before anyone finds them.”

“What are they doing here?” Léa moved from side to side, fear like an electrical current surging through her body.

He put the rifle in the canvas bag, then took out another. “Édouard’s been storing them for us. He’s a good man. We don’t know how they caught on to him or why they picked him up. But now that he’s in detention, we must get these out of here to protect his family and our network.”

Léa’s head spun. Worry gnawed at her, sharpening with every rifle he removed from the barrel and placed in the bag. “Are there other barrels?”

“Two more. Are you going to stand there staring or help?”

She stepped forward. “Who was Édouard working for?”

“The Resistance. Now, continue unloading this one while I open the other barrels. Once these are out of here, there’s no reason for the Nazi bastards to accuse the family of any involvement. Everyone will be safe.”